

Resume Checklist

General Format

☐	Have you used Microsoft Word? Do not use a template; applicant tracking systems have trouble reading it.
☐	Are the margins consistent and > 0.5 inches and < 1 inch?
☐	Is your font size > 10 pt and < 12 pt? Is the font easy to read (Arial or Times New Roman, etc.)?
☐	Have you kept it to one page? You may use two pages if you have an advanced degree or extensive experience (10+ years).
☐	Have you left enough white space to make it easy to read?
☐	Have you used boldface and italics appropriately (headers or positions) and avoided underlining?
☐	Are dates clear and consistent? Is format and punctuation consistent?
☐	Are sections listed in order of importance to the employer?
☐	Are heading names descriptive (e.g. Research Experience, Leadership & Service, etc.)?

Contact Information

☐	Is your legal name clear and bold at the top? (also on the second page if applicable)
☐	Is your phone number included? Do you have a professional voicemail recorded?
☐	Is your email address included? Does it sound professional?
☐	If you are a U.S. citizen or hold a permanent resident VISA, did you include this if readers might think otherwise?

Education

☐	Are college/university names spelled out? (i.e. Massachusetts Institute of Technology not MIT)
☐	Did you list the official name of your degree or course?
☐	Did you list the month and year you earned, or expect to earn, your degree?
☐	Did you consider listing your GPA if strong (include scale if you list the GPA)
☐	Did you list coursework that aligns with your job search?

Experience

☐	Did you clearly list the organization/company name and your job title?
☐	Did you include the city and state (or country) in which you worked?
☐	Are the dates of employment listed for each?
☐	Did you list the project, activity, and results for each experience?
☐	Did you start each phrase with an action verb? (tenses: Past for past work, present for ongoing work)
☐	Did you give evidence and quantify relevant information (e.g. size, scale, budget, staff) for impact?
☐	Have you used keywords that apply to your industry and/or the job listings?
☐	Have you avoided the use of "I"?
☐	Have you considered and included all aspects of your experiences related to the job opening(s)?

Skills

☐	Have you included all relevant skill types (Programming languages, Foreign language, Lab skills, etc.)?
☐	Did you list all relevant skills within each skill type?

Activities/Honors/Leadership

☐	Did you list the activities, honors, and/or leadership experiences that are relevant?
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